the same time. In this context, here are a couple of news items:

It's Curtains for Kiran Bedi's IPS Career

The government has finally accepted the request of the first woman IPS officer of the country Kiran Bedi seeking voluntary retirement from the service. Bedi had applied for retirement in November [2007], 19 months ahead of her superannuation.

The Ramon Magsaysay award winner, who joined the IPS in 1972, will now 'fully work on her own' with a woman empowerment programme at the panchayat level as her first post-retirement mission.

The Union home ministry decided to relieve Bedi, who was holding the post of director-general of the Bureau of Police Research and Development, from her duties …

After getting the Centre's formal letter, a relieved Bedi told *TOI* that she was now completely free to work for the people without any interference and confrontation. She said: 'I am now a total master of myself.' Asked whether she would accept any offer from the government which had last week hinted at utilizing her services for its National Police Mission project, Bedi said: 'I have had enough of a government job. I will now certainly not work "for" the government but "with" the government through my different projects.' Elaborating, she said that her NGOs – Navjyoti and India Vision Foundation – have been working on different projects with [limited] support from the government. 'Woman empowerment programmes in rural areas and creating leadership among them at the panchayat level will be the first task I will take up,' she said. Bedi had, in fact, made her intention clear while submitting her application for VRS [voluntary retirement scheme] saying she wanted to quit to pursue 'strong academic and social interests'.

Her VRS application had come a few months after the government overlooked her for the post of Delhi Police Commissioner and instead appointed her junior in the Union territory IPS cadre, Y. S. Dadwal. At that time, she had publicly expressed her resentment over this. During her 35 years' career, she served in various capacities in the Delhi Police and outside, including the United Nations. As DCP (Traffic), she earned the epithet of 'Crane' Bedi for towing away wrongly parked vehicles of VIPs, including the then PM Indira Gandhi.

(*The Times of India*, 28 December 2007)

Bedi Bids Adieu to Khaki

Kiran Bedi, the first woman IPS officer of the country, on Wednesday [26 December] bid farewell to her police career, after the Union Government accepted her request for voluntary retirement.

Bedi received her relieving letter from the Union Home Ministry on 24 December, bringing to an end her long association with the police force.

In July, … the Magsaysay awardee had alleged that the Government was biased towards women in police, when she was overlooked for the post of Delhi Police Commissioner.

'I have some exciting plans. Travelling and writing are on [the] cards. It will be hectic days for me,' said Bedi, who was serving as Director General of Bureau of Police Research and